📝 Notes

Feb 2, 2026

Fujimats & Firestationfurniture Workflows/Customization Review

Invited John Miranda Elaine Chow Barbara Stevenson Eric Tran

Attachments Fujimats & Firestationfurniture Workflows/Customization Review

Meeting records Transcript Recording

Summary

John Miranda and Eric Tran met to discuss the workflows and customizations for three accounts (Fuji Mats, Fire Station Furniture, and USA Fleet Solutions) to better understand the needs of the Manufacturing, Wholesale, and Distribution (MWD) customer segment. Eric Tran detailed the highly customized workflows for Fire Station Furniture and Fuji Mats, noting that Fire Station Furniture uses opportunities as a project tracker and a custom "proofs" app for logo sign-offs, while Fuji Mats uses sales orders for project tracking and accepts deposits toward the sales order before conversion. Both Fire Station Furniture and Fuji Mats track manufacturing primarily through activities, though Eric Tran provided the niche example of SCS Automations using a custom "sharpening app" for detailed work tracking.

Details

- **Meeting Objective and Audience** John Miranda and Eric Tran met to discuss the workflows and customizations for specific accounts (Fuji Mats, Fire Station Furniture, and USA Fleet Solutions) to better understand the needs of the Manufacturing, Wholesale, and Distribution (MWD) customer segment, which is a key investment area for 2026 (00:00:00). John Miranda confirmed that Eric Tran is the best resource for this topic, as the majority of Eric Tran's accounts fall

under the MWD vertical. Eric Tran noted that USA Fleet Solutions is a service account, not an MWD account (00:00:40).

- **Fire Station Furniture Business and Workflow** Fire Station Furniture sells fireproof furniture to fire stations, targeting states prone to wildfires, and operates as a B2B business (00:02:33). Eric Tran detailed their highly customized workflow, which begins with an opportunity that serves as their project tracker (00:01:33) (00:04:23). Key steps include creating and sending an estimate, which when accepted, automatically triggers updates to the opportunity stage (00:01:33) (00:07:22).
- **Customizations for Fire Station Furniture** Eric Tran described several customizations for Fire Station Furniture, including the ability to create vendor activities (00:04:23). They also developed a custom app called "proofs" which allows customers to sign off on embroidered logo designs for custom furniture via the customer portal, typically in between the estimate and invoice stages (00:05:38). Furthermore, the opportunity stages were expanded beyond the deal being won to track post-acceptance steps such as contacting vendors, taking payment, and sending the invoice (00:09:15).
- **Purchasing and Manufacturing for Fire Station Furniture** When an estimate is accepted, a purchase order is automatically created, referencing preferred vendors due to customizations (00:10:11). Activities are created to remind staff to follow up with vendors regarding shipping and completion status. Manufacturing and logistics, including shipping, are primarily tracked outside of Method through activities and notes in memos and invoices, as they do not use a shipping API or tracking within Method (00:11:06).
- **Payment and Document Usage for Fire Station Furniture** Fire Station Furniture no longer uses Method's payment portal due to previous issues before a platform update, instead relying on check or QuickBooks Online (QBO) payments, with the invoice syncing to QBO for collection (00:15:39). Eric Tran also noted that this customer does not utilize sales orders, which are generally seen in the industry for purposes like a packing list or check-and-balance document (00:16:23).
- **Fire Station Furniture Team Structure and Core Problem** The Fire Station Furniture team is small, consisting of four people—sales rep, operations, and two customer support staff—enabled by Method's automations (00:18:13). Eric Tran summarized their core problem as an organizational issue, where Method serves

as a central database to organize and manage all the moving parts of their complicated process (00:21:11).

- **Fuji Mats Business and Workflow** Fuji Mats is a very large and famous company in the fighting world, known for producing mats for disciplines like jiu-jitsu (00:22:46). Their workflow is hyper-complicated, starting with an estimate that contains extensive details and a micro dashboard for expected revenue (00:23:40). After the estimate is accepted, it is converted into a sales order, which then functions as the primary tracking document (similar to an opportunity) and involves a handoff from the sales team to operations and then to invoicing (00:24:37).
- **Fuji Mats Customizations and Payment Practices** Fuji Mats utilizes sales orders as their project tracking mechanism, which is an add-on after the estimate is approved (00:24:37) (00:26:38). Unlike typical industry practices, they accept payments (deposits) towards the sales order before conversion, and this payment is applied when the sales order is converted to an invoice (00:27:34). They also track shipping (containers) within Method, though this information is manually input, not via an API (00:31:51).
- **Manufacturing Tracking in MWD Accounts** John Miranda noted that both Fire Station Furniture and Fuji Mats track manufacturing processes primarily via activities, not full manufacturing detail within Method (00:12:21) (00:28:26). Eric Tran provided an example of SCS Automations, a company that records the results of repair work for tool modules using a custom "sharpening app," which is a unique example of tracking detailed work within Method, though very niche to their industry (00:29:18).
- **Common Customization Requests for MWD Customers** Regarding common customizations for MWD customers, Eric Tran identified the "Estimates" app and "terms and conditions" as highly requested features (00:32:45). Terms and conditions are a massive feature request that customers often require to be displayed on the customer portal or as a completely separate document (00:33:33).

Suggested next steps

- [ ] John Miranda will book another session with Eric Tran, preferably next week, to go over Fuji Mats in more depth.

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📖 Transcript

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00:00:00

John Miranda: turn on the
Eric Tran: Right.
John Miranda: video.
Eric Tran: And then are is Elaine, Barbara, and everybody else joining us?
John Miranda: Uh, no one else can join, so it's just me and you.
Eric Tran: Oh, okay. Cool. Cool. We can get started
John Miranda: Yeah. Yeah. So, like, uh,
Eric Tran: then.
John Miranda: I know the title include I mentioned Fuji Mats and Fire Station, but I also recognize you also did USA Fleet Solutions. So, if you can go through those three accounts like and just show me like their workflows,
Eric Tran: Yeah.
John Miranda: the customizations that you did.
Eric Tran: Sure, sure, sure, sure,
John Miranda: problems and pain points that would be
Eric Tran: sure. Yeah.
John Miranda: appreciated.
Eric Tran: Yeah. So, what are you guys doing this for, if you don't mind me
John Miranda: Yeah. So,
Eric Tran: asking?
John Miranda: you know how one of our investments for 2026 is winning the MWD customer. Um, we want to understand like what their workflows are and how we can actually win them over because they're our

00:00:40

Eric Tran: Yeah.
John Miranda: high there are they're are like our biggest customer segment and they drive our most retention.
Eric Tran: Yeah.
John Miranda: So, we want to optimize our platform for this specific vertical.
Eric Tran: So yeah, that's I'm kind of your guy for that if that's the case.
John Miranda: You're you're our guy for that.
Eric Tran: I have majority of my accounts are just to make sure WMD is wholesale and yeah,
John Miranda: Uh manufacturing, wholesale, distribution.
Eric Tran: that's definitely that's definitely mine. Yeah,
John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: I pro a lot of my accounts basically do that.
John Miranda: Amazing.
Eric Tran: USA Police Solutions does not do that. I don't know why you're picking that account though.
John Miranda: Really? What uh what uh what vertical are they?
Eric Tran: They they're not wholesale manufacturing. They're just they're just service. They're services, dude. They just Yeah,
John Miranda: Oh yeah.
Eric Tran: they don't. So, what they here, I'll take you through all their workflow so you can and then you can you can decide

00:01:33

John Miranda: Okay,
Eric Tran: yourself.
John Miranda: sure.
Eric Tran: So, Fire Station Furniture is simple yet complicated, I would say. So, first things first,
John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: they have a lot of recurring customers. So, they already have a really large customer base. So it's not really some they're not really taking in new leads so to speak but sometimes they do but for their workflow everything starts at the opportunity. This is highly highly customized. So usually opportunities take roughly a week sorry a month

right so they last about a month. I'm not too sure how they get them in so to speak but they make basically everything starts from making the opportunity right I'm not sure how they get those leads etc but for example so the main flow right is to from an opportunity they want to basically create an estimate
John Miranda: Uh, one thing, Eric, before you even go into the workflow, Could you just go over like what Fire Station does? Like what what's their
Eric Tran: oh sure yeah so fire station furniture.

00:02:33

John Miranda: business?
Eric Tran: Uh what they do is that they're really really cool. These are This is I think one of my cooler accounts. What they do is that they sell fireproof furniture to fire
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: stations. All right. Yeah. So fire station furniture. Let me just see really really quick. Um basically, uh Brandon, the guy I work with,
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: the owner, used to be a firefighter and he retired.
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: But basically he makes fire they make basically uh fire station furniture like furniture for fire stations and then also fireproof furniture. So for example they really target like states that are prone to wildfires right
John Miranda: Wow.
Eric Tran: and they will make all this furniture for them right so beds dining room lockers storage right but they are super cool.
John Miranda: Wow. That that's really neat. I didn't know that was even existed,
Eric Tran: Yeah.
John Miranda: that type of industry.
Eric Tran: Yeah. Yeah. And they're they're big.

00:03:33

Eric Tran: They're they're really really big.
John Miranda: So, are your main uh um clients like fire stations,
Eric Tran: But like Yes.

John Miranda: I assume,
Eric Tran: Yep.
John Miranda: or like B2B?
Eric Tran: All fire station B2B. So this is a B2B. This is a B2B business.
John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: They try to B to B to sorry what you call it business to retail, right? I don't know what you guys call it, but like that did not work out. Um yes,
John Miranda: I see.
Eric Tran: but this this definitely anyways they sell, you know, sell furniture to fire stations.
John Miranda: Got it.
Eric Tran: So Oh
John Miranda: So they make their own furniture and then they like distribute it to fire stations as well. Okay. Got
Eric Tran: yeah.
John Miranda: it.
Eric Tran: So what happens is that they'll create an estimate right and they will you know send they'll email it to the customer right saying hey they want to
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: accept the esper or not right so then once that you know that's a typical process we have habit method so it's fine then once it comes back this is where it gets complicated right so they

00:04:23

John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: will have to they have to email out their vendors right basically all the parts that they need right so they have this button down here that says create vendor activities which will
John Miranda: Mhm. Mhm.
Eric Tran: create reminders for the team to contact the vendors and get these parts. Right?
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: So from here you can create a purchase order. Right?
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: What it'll do is that it'll create a purchase order with these preferred vendors. Right?

John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: And it'll go into a purchase order over here. And within within this right there are activities they have to
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: complete right to make sure that this order goes through right so for example
John Miranda: Mhm. Mhm.
Eric Tran: you know emailing their basically emailing their um excuse me their creators I don't know what they call the manufacturers and asking them like hey please complete the headrest please get this part please
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: get this part and they assemble it right once it's all done right then it gets assembled right and it gets shipped to the customer and then as as all this is going on the opportunity is moving in stage right so they're using an opportunities as sort of their

00:05:38

John Miranda: Gotcha. Mhm.
Eric Tran: project tracker but they would like for example they say like the quote was sent it was
John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: shipped it was ordered it was paid it was approved etc
John Miranda: Mhm. Yeah.
Eric Tran: right so that's kind of their workflow right and in between that
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: right. This is a little bit custom. Uh if you see on their website, they have custom like logo furniture,
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: which is sort of their new thing that they've done where you can embroider their logo basically of their fire station.
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: So,
John Miranda: Nice.
Eric Tran: what I've done is created basically a custom app. Oh, sorry. Where did it go? Oh, sorry. I have too many screens open. So I created a custo something called proofs, right? Where basically they can upload logos for their customers to sign on their portal, right? Just to make the process a little bit easier.
John Miranda: Mhm.

00:06:32

Eric Tran: So for example, like, hey, this is what your furniture is going to look like, right? And they can either choose to accept that specific proof.
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: And again, it's all tied to that
John Miranda: Gotcha.
Eric Tran: opportunity.
John Miranda: So would that come like uh would that be part of like the estimate stage then or no?
Eric Tran: Uh it would be on top. It would be in between the estimate to invoice. It's like, hey, by the way, I also want a little bit of customization. So there's like a little in between step. That's the that's the part where it comes in.
John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: But it's the same process where uh let me see if I can find you a example. They're able to basically email out a proof to their customer, right?
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: And they're able to accept or reject it and then give their reason. Very similar to the estimate process. So, yes, it was it's like right out.
John Miranda: I I see.

00:07:22

Eric Tran: It's like it's an add-on to the aspect process, so to speak.
John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: Yeah.
John Miranda: Nice.
Eric Tran: Yeah.
John Miranda: Um one question I did have was um so you the opportunity is basically like the
Eric Tran: Yeah.
John Miranda: project tracking. Um you have these different stages in the opportunity. Do they automatically move or based on they do
Eric Tran: Yes, they automatically move every time we create an estimate,

John Miranda: right?
Eric Tran: create an activity, payment is made, right? I've set up a lot of customization where it just keeps continually updating the uh the opportunity. In fact, accepting the aspet carries over information from the aspet to the opportunity. So for example, if you scroll down,
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: there's customer order notes,
John Miranda: Well,
Eric Tran: right? So customers will type in what they want, right? It'll come over. And then you have the internal notes, of course, the usual ones, right? And then down here, you can again you can see the all the associated purchase orders they have to make.

00:08:19

Eric Tran: So everything, all the attachments. So when this gets saved, this also gets saved to the customer level.
John Miranda: Oh, nice.
Eric Tran: So if you go in,
John Miranda: Wow.
Eric Tran: they can see every single file they've ever created for that customer, right? So basically like in case a customer calls back and goes,
John Miranda: Yeah.
Eric Tran: "Hey, I really like that piece of furniture. Can you go find it for me?" There's a place for them to look for it here in
John Miranda: Nice.
Eric Tran: Method.
John Miranda: And um could you walk me through all the opportunity stages? Are they like unique to this specific customer or are they like similar to like what we have by
Eric Tran: they are pretty unique I would say.
John Miranda: default?
Eric Tran: So they don't really have that prospecting or anything like that, right? It's just,
John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: you know, the estimate was sent, right? The or it'll they'll purchase in the future.
John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: That's another thing, right? So it's really it's really more of like a project tracker, right?

00:09:15

John Miranda: Gotcha.
Eric Tran: Like where are we in this life this person's sorry the um the life cycle of this deal, right? So that I would say anything anything before quoting is rarely
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: rarely used right all that all that all that stock stuff that prospecting they don't use it
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: right like it's an estimate into you know acceptance shipped etc
John Miranda: Gotcha.
Eric Tran: right I think what we're what we're lacking a lot in the opportunities for the specific customer was that there was nothing after the deal was won right there's nothing that tracks the deal was one, right? After the deal is won, it's like what else is next, right?
John Miranda: So the deal winning is when they accept the estimate.
Eric Tran: So that yes,
John Miranda: Yes. Right.
Eric Tran: right?
John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: That's kind of when they accept the estimate, but there are steps after that,
John Miranda: Yeah.
Eric Tran: right? It's like, you know, we need to contact their vendors,
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: we have to take their payment, we have to send the invoice, right?

00:10:11

Eric Tran: So we've expanded the opportunities beyond that to capture that
John Miranda: Gotcha.
Eric Tran: information.
John Miranda: Okay. So once the customer accepts the estimate from the portal um a purchase order is created or it's manually created. The user would have to go in click like create purchase order and then um uh is a purchase order

Eric Tran: Mhm. Mhm.
John Miranda: like automatically like referencing um the vendors for this finished good like I know
Eric Tran: Yes.
John Miranda: it automatically does that.
Eric Tran: They use C through customization again. Again,
John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: they um we set up a thing where you they set up preferred vendors so that when a purchase order when SP is accepted and then the purchase order is created,
John Miranda: Yeah.
Eric Tran: it takes those preferred vendors automatically spits out a purchase order for them.
John Miranda: Nice. Okay. So then once that purchase order is created,
Eric Tran: Right.
John Miranda: it gets sent to the vendor. Um u and then uh what happens after that? They would have to receive these items,

00:11:06

Eric Tran: Right.
John Miranda: right?
Eric Tran: So then there's activities made to remind them to follow up with that vendor,
John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: right?
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: And say like, hey, was this shipped? Was this completed? Once that's all done, then it gets shipped to the customer and the customer gets paid. And that is recorded here as well,
John Miranda: I see.
Eric Tran: right?
John Miranda: So in between that stage between like getting the materials and shipping it to the customer is any of the manufacturing aspect uh tracked and method or like uh
Eric Tran: The only part it's really tracked is through the activities,
John Miranda: okay.
Eric Tran: right? That's how they're tracking it. Like,
John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: hey, uh, hold on. Let me just see if I can find one. Nope. Um, that's weird,

right? So, for example, headrest completed, headrest shipped, right? Sunb Belt delivery, stitch pallet approved,
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: right? That's their current way. There's no current way of being able to track in method.

00:12:21

Eric Tran: We haven't built that way just because it's kind of been separate from their system.
John Miranda: Okay. So,
Eric Tran: Right.
John Miranda: they use like a totally different system for like manufacturing.
Eric Tran: I'm not Yeah, I'm not too involved in that. So, I'm not too sure. This is just to keep track of the manufacturing though.
John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: They don't actually like put the manufacturing details in,
John Miranda: Gotcha.
Eric Tran: right?
John Miranda: I see.
Eric Tran: Are you trying to look for companies that actually put more manufacturing details in than what they record?
John Miranda: Um I'm just trying to understand more of their how they use method and like what are the gaps right now? Like okay, it seems like they do manufacturing outside of method and here they're just more so recording them based on activities. So like we just want to see the strengths of their workflow in comparison to how like other companies would be using
Eric Tran: Yes.
John Miranda: method which is interesting. Um and you also mentioned they they ship it via like they ship they ship and track

00:13:02

Eric Tran: Okay.
John Miranda: using um oper uh activities right but they don't have any shipping uh or

logistics within method though either it's just activities.
Eric Tran: No, it's exactly. It's just activities and like there's they put tracking numbers in their memos and
John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: invoices, right? So, no,
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: that's not this one. I guess I should look at the invoice, but I've seen other companies where they will produce a tracking
John Miranda: Gotcha.
Eric Tran: number.
John Miranda: Do you know how this company produces it? Like do they use like a external API or like an integration or no?
Eric Tran: I have I I have no idea.
John Miranda: Gotcha.
Eric Tran: I'm sorry.
John Miranda: That's funny.
Eric Tran: I know other customers I know, but not not this specific one. Yeah, I'm not sure.
John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: But like some I know that certain use certain customers like that I've worked with or that I know of that our team works with, they do they use stuff like ship station and other APIs where they will basically transfer all that information

00:14:03

John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: over and produce a shipping label in the third in the third party system.
John Miranda: Makes
Eric Tran: The other the other very common asks that we get for these type of customers,
John Miranda: sense.
Eric Tran: right, is we put in a tracking number for them that's visible for the customer and internally.
John Miranda: Nice.
Eric Tran: That's a that's another thing that we don't have.
John Miranda: Okay. And that would be a customization that you
Eric Tran: That's that's a very common request.

John Miranda: implement.
Eric Tran: Exactly. But it's just a text a text box,
John Miranda: I see.
Eric Tran: right?
John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: Either that or they use a the customer message to put the tracking in number there. Right. But I guess what the the thing I'm just trying to point out is that tracking number is a very commonly
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: requested thing especially with these type of companies right they'll use it
John Miranda: Okay. Yeah. So, how would the customer see this tracking number?

00:14:51

Eric Tran: right be through an
John Miranda: Like, would that be through an email or Okay.
Eric Tran: email on their print template on their portal just anywhere where it's visible
John Miranda: Yeah. Okay. It's just a field.
Eric Tran: right exactly well depends if they have an
John Miranda: It's not autogenerated though. Okay.
Eric Tran: API hooked up like we set up API for them Yes,
John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: we can autogenerate for them, right?
John Miranda: Gotcha.
Eric Tran: But most of the time it's just an input, right? So,
John Miranda: Makes sense.
Eric Tran: for example, they would put in the customer message in this case, right?
John Miranda: Um,
Eric Tran: Because they don't have their own separate field, but I know other customers that do.
John Miranda: makes sense. Okay.
Eric Tran: Yeah.
John Miranda: So, uh, basically after they ship it,
Eric Tran: Okay.
John Miranda: um, then they would collect payment, right? That's where they would create an invoice.
Eric Tran: Next.

John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: Yes.
John Miranda: Invoice. And then, um, the customer would pay it through the portal.

00:15:39

Eric Tran: This one used to, but we stopped because because payment portal kept having issues.
John Miranda: Why? Oh, okay.
Eric Tran: It was way back when before the new update. Like like credit cards wouldn't wouldn't apply, fees kept like things kept dropping,
John Miranda: Uh
Eric Tran: right? Like like payments wouldn't be recorded properly. But this is before we had the update. They've been a longtime customer and they kind of got sick of it's like we're not doing this anymore. Sorry, Eric.
John Miranda: oh. Okay. So, what do they use now then to collect payment or how?
Eric Tran: Uh this is take check or QuickBooks online
John Miranda: Oh, okay.
Eric Tran: payments.
John Miranda: Okay. So, the invoice would sync over into QBO and then from there they'll be collecting payment.
Eric Tran: Yes. Yes. I they initially used the portal but because of the issues that they had with shuttle and before your
John Miranda: Uh
Eric Tran: time right they um they gave up like we don't want this Eric.

00:16:23

John Miranda: yeah,
Eric Tran: I'm like okay sorry right but it's it's fixed now.
John Miranda: gotcha. and
Eric Tran: I I don't want to force them to go back into it if they don't want to, but it's better now. Technically can do it,
John Miranda: yeah
Eric Tran: but like they they they gave up on it just how bad our bad bad our payment

processor was like a couple years back.
John Miranda: no for sure man and um another question I had was like at no one point that I hear anything about
Eric Tran: Yeah.
John Miranda: sales orders is that not something that they use uh
Eric Tran: No, they don't. Well, they used to,
John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: but they don't. I see sales orders in this type of industry I feel is more of a packing
John Miranda: A packing list.
Eric Tran: list and it's like a it's like um I mean sometimes people use the estimate as a
John Miranda: Interesting.
Eric Tran: packing list too but sometime like there are many uses for it but it's sort of just like something you send to you know the the manufacturer or just as it's like a check and balance kind of thing.

00:17:22

Eric Tran: It's like hey this is your order are you sure you want this? Right? So either internally either for the customer, right? But it doesn't actually really do anything else so to speak in their process.
John Miranda: Okay, makes sense.
Eric Tran: Yeah.
John Miranda: At least not for this customer. They don't find any use in it.
Eric Tran: No, I've seen other customers do use it though as a packing list and as an internal tool where it's like has this shipped,
John Miranda: Yeah. Mhm.
Eric Tran: has that, you know, has that not shipped, right?
John Miranda: Gotcha.
Eric Tran: Etc. Right.
John Miranda: So like for this specific workflow like how many like individuals are typically involved? Like do you know like the type of persona who would be operating here?
Eric Tran: It's four four different
John Miranda: four different like who would they be and at what point in stage would they like jump
Eric Tran: people.

John Miranda: in
Eric Tran: So, this guy is new, so I have no idea what he does. I have no clue.

00:18:13

John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: But Terry's in charge of purchase orders.
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: And then Sissy or Kristen are in charge of the opportunities. And I think Lizzie does
John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: estimates.
John Miranda: So, like do you know what type of like role they are at fire station?
Eric Tran: Well, let's look it up.
John Miranda: True.
Eric Tran: Uh, where is contact? Oh gosh.
John Miranda: It was all the way at the bottom. Yeah, I'm only asking cuz I'm just curious on like the type of persona. Is it like more sales oriented? Is it more like uh um like uh warehouse operator oriented?
Eric Tran: It's literally one sales rep operations
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: and customer support and two customer two customer supports sales rep operations and that's it. And you know Mr. president.
John Miranda: Gotcha. Okay, that's basically their team.
Eric Tran: So yeah, that's it.
John Miranda: Uhhuh. Okay.
Eric Tran: They Yeah,
John Miranda: Wow.
Eric Tran: so they it's really basically method allowed them to have such a small team just because it's so much automation.

00:19:33

John Miranda: Yeah.
Eric Tran: They were able to because like otherwise we'd take several people,

John Miranda: Yeah. Yeah. Yeah. Makes sense. Okay.
Eric Tran: right?
John Miranda: So it's majority of it is just like the sales team or a sales operation team that's managing the entire workflow.
Eric Tran: Correct.
John Miranda: Interesting. Okay.
Eric Tran: And then this and then the CEO sometimes just uh you
John Miranda: Yeah.
Eric Tran: know yeah
John Miranda: Okay. So other than the other than the proofs for the uh the images,
Eric Tran: just
John Miranda: that was like the only custom app that you built for um this
Eric Tran: yes but otherwise um no well one big thing I guess cuz
John Miranda: customer.
Eric Tran: I don't think this is stock I don't remember it's been a while but you can't create activities for
John Miranda: Oh,
Eric Tran: vendors I'm 99% sure like you can't
John Miranda: okay. Mhm.
Eric Tran: make vendor activities. Let me just check the stock page. So that's a big customization I think like again it's still within our stock apps I would

00:20:26

John Miranda: Yeah.
Eric Tran: say but it's like a big bigger thing so to speak right that I think we have to
John Miranda: Mhm. Yeah.
Eric Tran: recognize is that activities do not only just belong to
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: customers they can also belong to vendors right that's the one thing I think we lack but let me I
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: could be wrong let me double check that maybe maybe that's changed maybe because it's been a while cuz activity is based off the entity table,
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: right? But for some reason,
John Miranda: Mhm.

Eric Tran: I think we limit it just to customers and leads. Let me just check.
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: Yeah. Oh, no, we don't. Okay, never mind. We don't. Okay, I lied. Okay,
John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: I guess that's changed. I'm sorry. It's been a while.
John Miranda: All good.
Eric Tran: Okay. Okay.
John Miranda: All good.
Eric Tran: Okay. Okay. But yeah, um but other than that,

00:21:11

John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: everything is mostly within uh our stock apps. It's just a lot of automation,
John Miranda: Yeah,
Eric Tran: so to speak, that I put for them.
John Miranda: makes sense. Okay. Okay. And like if you could like summarize in like uh one sentence like what was like the core problem
Eric Tran: Yeah,
John Miranda: that um fire station was trying to solve and uh with method
Eric Tran: it was really organizing all the steps into one central location where
John Miranda: it
Eric Tran: it could be managed, right? It was really an organizational issue, not really the manufacturing just because it's just fire station furniture has so many moving parts and method was kind of their central database to keep everything together in one place and track them. Yeah,
John Miranda: Nice.
Eric Tran: that's it.
John Miranda: Cool. Uh, awesome.
Eric Tran: Yeah.
John Miranda: I think this is like really good information. Thanks for all this insight. Um, I know we're at 10:55,
Eric Tran: Yeah.
John Miranda: but do you have like a couple more minutes?

00:22:06

Eric Tran: Yeah. For like a bit and I got to go. Yeah.
John Miranda: Okay. Can we uh can we go over what's the other account?
Eric Tran: Uh uh.
John Miranda: Fuji Mats then?
Eric Tran: Oh dear.
John Miranda: Oh,
Eric Tran: This Oh dear.
John Miranda: no.
Eric Tran: This account is is very very complicated. I have had this account for maybe four months.
John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: I still do not.
John Miranda: Yeah,
Eric Tran: I don't understand what's going on. I just I don't know if this how helpful this is going to be.
John Miranda: really.
Eric Tran: But I I'll tell you the workflow. Okay.
John Miranda: Okay. Okay.
Eric Tran: I'll try.
John Miranda: Yeah, I appreciate it, man. Thank you. Yeah, we Yeah,
Eric Tran: So So you're good.
John Miranda: continue. Yeah, sorry.
Eric Tran: So everything starts off with an estimate.
John Miranda: Oh, sorry. I can't see your screen. I think it's still on the fire station one.
Eric Tran: Oh,

00:22:46

John Miranda: Yeah.
Eric Tran: okay.
John Miranda: Yeah,
Eric Tran: Okay.
John Miranda: I see it.
Eric Tran: So Fujim is actually I didn't know this. I learned this the other day. They're really famous. Apparently they're really famous company. They're they're huge in the in

the uh fighting world, right? They make they make, you know,
John Miranda: Really?
Eric Tran: all those mats people like all for like I guess you know like karate or like just uh jiu-jitsu, right? They make all those mats.
John Miranda: Yeah.
Eric Tran: They're the like the biggest producer.
John Miranda: Wow,
Eric Tran: Yeah, they're they're huge.
John Miranda: they're huge.
Eric Tran: Like I I didn't know this because like they're huge. Apparent like my guy who uh I think his name Nick from my team, he does like jiu-jitsu, right? He's like, "Oh my god, Fuji Mats, they're so cool." Right? I was like, "Really?" like really big. I didn't know but apparently they're freaking huge,
John Miranda: Yeah.
Eric Tran: right?
John Miranda: No way.
Eric Tran: Like like you know you know Joe apparently did business with Joe Rogan and like all those all those big

00:23:40

John Miranda: That's insane.
Eric Tran: people.
John Miranda: Holy. Wow. That's crazy.
Eric Tran: Yeah. Yeah. Yeah.
John Miranda: Wow.
Eric Tran: These guys were freaking huge,
John Miranda: Yeah.
Eric Tran: right? But their work process is hyper complicated.
John Miranda: Wow.
Eric Tran: So I'll try my best to describe as soon as I can. So first everything starts off with an
John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: estimate. They'll make an estimate, right? But as you can see, they're like, "Where does it go? What is it for? Custom? What are we waiting for?" Right? Is it a parent?
John Miranda: Mhm.

Eric Tran: Is it a child estimate? etc. Right? But it kind of starts here, right? And they'll add in all their items.
John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: They add in all their shipping charges, which is separated, right? They'll email it to the customer.
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: There are several ways you can email it. You can email, you can show it, they can show the discount, they can hide discount, they can show it as an order.

00:24:37

Eric Tran: There's related activities,
John Miranda: Wow.
Eric Tran: there's related estimates,
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: related sales orders, there's even a micro dashboard for how much money they think they'll make for the specific customer,
John Miranda: Wow. Yeah, that's insane.
Eric Tran: right?
John Miranda: Just from an estimate.
Eric Tran: Yes. Just from an estimate. So once the estimate is created,
John Miranda: Wow.
Eric Tran: it goes, so that's the easy part. This is the easy part. The estimate gets sent, gets accepted, then it goes into a sales order. The sales order, this is where everything goes nuts where basically there's there's different processes.
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: There's like so they treat the sales order as their opportunity, so to speak.
John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: All right. Oh, I got to publish this so I don't forget.
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: I'm going to get it. So basically what happens is that um after the sales orders aspect gets approved comes into the sales orders teams take over right so for example it starts with the sales team right just making sure like hey was this correct the customer accept it boom

00:25:35

John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: right then what happens is that they'll ask there's a button here but it's hidden right they'll click a button they'll basically say okay this is good to go send it to operations operation takes over and then that's when sort of the manufacturing takes place where that's where the peel
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: gets create that's where the packing list created right and they take care of that right and then it's on the
John Miranda: Yeah. Yeah.
Eric Tran: PO side then once it's uh again this part is a bit vague so don't quote me
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: on this so once the PO has been you know once the PO has been uh basically received delivered etc right then it
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: so there's even a contact for that specific uh person, right?
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: So that once appeal is actually like received and then shipped to the customer,
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: then it then operation turns it over to invoicing and invoicing is the person and then that sales orders gets create um sorry converted into an invoice, right?

00:26:38

John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: I get synced with QuickBooks and then then they will email from QuickBooks.
John Miranda: Yeah.
Eric Tran: That's sort of their summary.
John Miranda: And to Okay.
Eric Tran: Yeah.
John Miranda: So, basically everything starts with an estimate. Then the estimate gets approved,
Eric Tran: Yeah.
John Miranda: goes into a sales order. It automatically gets created and then the sales order acts as like their opportunity tracking. goes from sales to operations um to

invoicing and between that steps
Eric Tran: to in to invoicing. Yep.
John Miranda: they would create a purchase order if they need materials to create Fuji mats for whichever customer
Eric Tran: Yep. Yeah.
John Miranda: that's ordering and then the they create the invoice and then they get
Eric Tran: Yep.
John Miranda: paid.
Eric Tran: Yep.
John Miranda: Okay, so that was like a like a very high level one and I when I'm looking through these screens there's so much going on like
Eric Tran: It's too much, dude. I I can't tell you because there's so many exceptions. So, it's not So, it's not just sales orders, but like they will create like pro-forma invoices.

00:27:34

Eric Tran: Like, there's different templates for different types of, right? So, different things.
John Miranda: Wow.
Eric Tran: They take payments towards sales orders which is not a that's not that's that's not
John Miranda: Really?
Eric Tran: normal in the in the industry in my opinion but basically instead of paying the
John Miranda: Wow.
Eric Tran: invoice they pay the sales they pay the deposit or they pay the sales order first then when that when that sales
John Miranda: Yeah.
Eric Tran: order gets converted invoice the payment is applied.
John Miranda: Oh, wow. That's that's different. It's not typically normal from what I've seen.
Eric Tran: Yeah because it's not like Yeah. Exactly right. like like they'll pay the ass but it still gets counted towards the sales order right so the sales order is not a
John Miranda: Yay!
Eric Tran: posting transaction right so it's completely hosted on a custom table and then once it actually you know
John Miranda: Uh-huh. Uh-huh.
Eric Tran: gets um created sorry gets converted then it you know um actually applies to

the real invoice but as you can see yeah but you can see up here this is when the asset created that's

00:28:26

John Miranda: Oh.
Eric Tran: when the sales order created that's when operations got it that's when the purchase order was made that's when it's going to be completed that's the tracking number The customer
John Miranda: Gotcha. So operations are basically the crew who uh uh I guess they um manage
Eric Tran: got
John Miranda: the entire like life cycle of the that specific product, right? Okay.
Eric Tran: Yeah.
John Miranda: Okay. So uh Fujimat also handles the whole manufacturing side but not within method here. It's just more so um the tracking of like whether things are have been completed or are on track.
Eric Tran: Yes,
John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: if you really want to see like a manufacturing account,
John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: I'll offer one more before I before I have to really go because we're kind of over time.
John Miranda: Yeah. Yeah. Sorry. Thank
Eric Tran: Uh, it's fine. It's fine.
John Miranda: you.
Eric Tran: But like where like I've seen an example of us them actually keeping track. It's not really manu It's kind of manufacturing, not really,

00:29:18

John Miranda: Okay.
Eric Tran: but like they will basically take in machines and like repair them, right? they will they will they will update their their cutting machines.
John Miranda: Uh-huh.

Eric Tran: So this is SCS automations they do sign making and die making. They sell sign making die making machines,
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: right? Um what they do is that like they will take in something called a tool module, right?
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: Which is basically like the little bit at the end of the machine that helps you cut signs and dyes,
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: right? And we created a completely custom app, something called the sharpening app, right? Again, this is unique to their industry. So, I don't know how much you can use this, right? But basically, it takes in like a customer will ship them like,
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: "Hey, I need this to be sharpened. I need you to fix this,
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: etc." Right? And then what will happen is that we created something called sharpening lock where like basically they'll record like the

00:30:06

John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: tool that they have, the original factory length, the actual length, etc., right? and they'll actually do the work. They'll grind it down. They'll fix it.
John Miranda: Yeah.
Eric Tran: They'll record the results here and they'll email that to the customer.
John Miranda: Wow. This is super niche for this
Eric Tran: It's exactly right. But like I'm pretty sure other I can't give you a generalization,
John Miranda: business.
Eric Tran: but like it's like a custom app where they're recording if we were to generalize it to record the results of that manufacturing or of that repair so to speak,
John Miranda: Mhm. Gotcha.
Eric Tran: right?
John Miranda: Yeah.
Eric Tran: And that that's kind of what they use method for sometimes. So, not all the time, right? That's part of the thing, right? But that's I guess that's more akin to having manufacturing within method, right?
John Miranda: Yeah,

Eric Tran: I would say, but it's very unique to their industry.
John Miranda: makes sense.
Eric Tran: It's not very general, unfortunately.

00:31:01

Eric Tran: Right. But this this is an example if you want to look at like you know what they do like for example printing a label,
John Miranda: Gotcha.
Eric Tran: printing a report, right?
John Miranda: Uh, and for like the I know we're running out of time.
Eric Tran: Yeah.
John Miranda: I just have a couple last questions like um we just highlight over um for like Fuji Mats and Fire Station
Eric Tran: Yeah.
John Miranda: like um they fire station doesn't handle inventory within method from what it sounds like right and Fuji mats do they handle inventory within method or
Eric Tran: That's right. They do,
John Miranda: no
Eric Tran: but they kind of let QuickBooks take care of it if I'm being honest.
John Miranda: okay I
Eric Tran: Yeah. So, if we go to Fuji Mats, we don't have an inventory system,
John Miranda: Hey.
Eric Tran: so to speak. What's this? Containers. Okay, that's a different one. Oh, this is this is their shipping actually if you want to see this. So containers is that these are these are ships.

00:31:51

Eric Tran: All these are big ships.
John Miranda: Oh, wow.
Eric Tran: They ship these mats right from like with these like with you know with
John Miranda: Uh-huh.
Eric Tran: these POS with these sales orders to their country so they can pick it up
John Miranda: Okay.

Eric Tran: right.
John Miranda: So they are tracking shipping within method then Fuji
Eric Tran: Yes, they are. They are.
John Miranda: Max
Eric Tran: But it's like it's not but it's there's no uh I don't know the exact I don't think there's there's no shipping API but this all handwritten right but it's like you know here you
John Miranda: makes sense. So
Eric Tran: know here's the container size number date right etc right you can see and they can see it in their portal as well
John Miranda: Mhm.
Eric Tran: etc right yeah but going back to your question
John Miranda: Wow. Okay.
Eric Tran: um they technically have an inventory dashboard.
John Miranda: Oh, nice. So, they are tracking like quantity on hand.
Eric Tran: Yes.
John Miranda: Are they tracking like and all those things expected?

00:32:45

Eric Tran: Wait, say that
John Miranda: Are they Oh, quantity on sales order on purchase order.
Eric Tran: again.
John Miranda: So they are tracking what's committed, what's expected
Eric Tran: Yes, but it's not a but I don't know if they use this anymore.
John Miranda: in Oh,
Eric Tran: I'm not too sure. Uh yeah, that's that's what I'm not too sure about.
John Miranda: okay.
Eric Tran: But it's not but it's not like no no automation. It's on ClickBook side. We're just displaying it in a way where it's more palpitable. It's easier to
John Miranda: Uhhuh. Okay,
Eric Tran: understand.
John Miranda: makes sense. All right. And uh I think one of my last questions for you is like uh uh what app do you see yourself customizing the most for MWDs? And um what's the most common customization request for MWD customers?
Eric Tran: Uh, it's estimates I would say, right? And terms and conditions.
John Miranda: Okay.

Eric Tran: You already have that in there. It's terms and conditions.
John Miranda: Okay.

00:33:33

Eric Tran: That's really really they're really big on that,
John Miranda: Yeah. Yeah. We that's a massive feature request terms and conditions.
Eric Tran: right?
John Miranda: Yeah.
Eric Tran: It's like these are your terms of accepting. Yes, right.
John Miranda: Yeah.
Eric Tran: That's huge.
John Miranda: And that's basically adding that into like the email templates.
Eric Tran: Nope.
John Miranda: I believe customer portal.
Eric Tran: Nope. Customer portal. So if you actually want to see Wait, you said manufacturing and distribution.
John Miranda: Yeah. Like wholesale, distribution,
Eric Tran: Okay. Okay.
John Miranda: manufacturing.
Eric Tran: Yeah. Yeah, it's definitely terms and conditions.
John Miranda: Okay. Okay. Makes
Eric Tran: Yeah. Just because it's sometimes but most of the times on the portal in addition to the estimate,
John Miranda: sense.
Eric Tran: but sometimes they'll ask for it as a separate document completely.
John Miranda: Really? Okay.
Eric Tran: Yep. That's related to that specific
John Miranda: Interesting. Okay.
Eric Tran: record.
John Miranda: Makes sense. And uh thanks so much, Eric.

Transcription ended after 00:34:36

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